

2026 FIFA World Cup

The **2026 FIFA World Cup**^[A] will be the 23rd edition of the [FIFA World Cup](#), the [quadrennial](#) international men's [soccer](#) championship contested by the [national teams](#) of the member associations of [FIFA](#). The tournament will take place from June 11 to July 19, 2026.^[2] It will be jointly hosted by sixteen cities—eleven in the United States, three in Mexico, and two in Canada. The tournament will be the first FIFA World Cup to be hosted by three nations, and the first to include 48 teams, an expansion from 32 previously.

The [United 2026 bid](#) beat a [rival bid](#) by [Morocco](#) during a final vote at the 68th FIFA Congress in [Moscow](#). It will be the first men's World Cup since 2002 to be co-hosted by multiple nations. With its past hosting of the 1970 and 1986 tournaments, Mexico will become the first country to host or co-host the men's World Cup three times. The United States previously hosted the men's World Cup in 1994. By contrast, it will be Canada's first time hosting or co-hosting the men's tournament. The event will return to its traditional [Northern Hemisphere](#) summer schedule after the [2022 World Cup](#) in Qatar was uniquely held in November and December.

As the host nations, [Canada](#), [Mexico](#), and the [United States](#) all automatically qualified. [Cape Verde](#), [Curaçao](#), [Jordan](#), and [Uzbekistan](#) will all make their World Cup debuts. [Argentina](#) is the [defending champion](#), having won its third World Cup title in 2022.

Format and expansion

The idea of expanding the tournament had been suggested as early as 2013 by then [UEFA](#) president [Michel Platini](#),^{[3][4]} and also in 2016 by FIFA president [Gianni Infantino](#).^[5] Opponents of the proposal argued that the number of matches played was already at an unacceptable level,^[6] that the expansion would dilute the quality of the matches,^{[7][8]} and that the decision was driven by political rather than sporting concerns, accusing Infantino of using the promise of bringing more countries to the World Cup to win his election.^[9]

Starting with this edition, the FIFA World Cup expanded to 48 teams, an increase of 16 teams compared to the previous seven tournaments.^[10] The teams will be split into twelve groups of four teams, with the top two teams in each group and the eight best third-placed teams progressing to a new round of 32, as approved by the [FIFA Council](#) on March 14, 2023.^[11] This is set to be the first expansion and format change since 1998.^[12]

The total number of matches played will increase from 64 to 104, and the number of matches played by teams reaching the final four will increase from seven to eight. The tournament will last 39 days, an increase from 32 days of the 2014 and 2018 tournaments.^{[13][14]} Each team will still play three group matches.^{[15][16]} The final matchday at club level for players named in the final squads is May 24, 2026; clubs have to release their players by May 25, with exceptions granted to players participating in continental club competition finals up until May 30. The 56 days of the combined rest, release, and tournament periods remain identical to the 2010, 2014 and 2018 tournaments.^[11]

Other expansion formats explored

The expansion to 48 teams had already been approved on January 10, 2017, when it was initially decided that the tournament would include 16 groups of 3 teams, and 80 matches in total, with the top two teams of each group progressing to a round of 32.^{[10][17]} Under this later-superseded format, the maximum number of matches per team would have remained at seven, but

2026 FIFA World Cup

FIFA World Cup 26

Copa Mundial de la FIFA 2026

Coupe du Monde de la FIFA 2026



Tournament details

Host countries	Canada Mexico United States
Dates	June 11 – July 19
Teams	48 (from 6 confederations)
Venue	16 (in 16 host cities)

← 2022

2030 →

each team would have played one fewer group match than before. The tournament would still have been completed within 32 days.^[18] This format was initially chosen over three other proposals, ranging from 40 to 48 teams, from 76 to 88 matches, and from one to four minimum matches per team.^{[19][20][21]}

Critics of this format argued that the use of three-team groups with two teams progressing significantly increased the risk of collusion between teams.^[22] This prompted FIFA to suggest that penalty shootouts may be used to prevent draws in the group stage,^[23] although even then some risk of collusion would remain, and a possibility would emerge of teams deliberately losing shootouts to eliminate a rival.^[22] To address these concerns, FIFA continued considering alternative formats^[24] – a process that ended with the 2023 announcement that the format would be 12 groups of 4 teams.

Host selection

The FIFA Council went back and forth between 2013 and 2017 on limitations within hosting rotation based on the continental confederations. Originally, it was set that bids to be host would not be allowed from countries belonging to confederations that hosted the two preceding tournaments. It was temporarily changed to only prohibit countries belonging to the confederation that hosted the previous World Cup from bidding to host the following tournament,^[25] before the rule was changed back to its prior state of two World Cups.^[26]

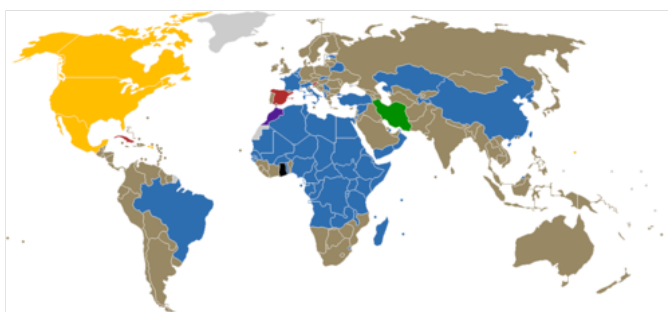
The FIFA Council made an exception to potentially grant eligibility to member associations of the confederation of the second-to-last host of the FIFA World Cup in the event that none of the received bids fulfill the strict technical and financial requirements.^{[27][28]} In March 2017, FIFA president Gianni Infantino confirmed that "Europe (UEFA) and Asia (AFC) are excluded from the bidding following the selection of Russia and Qatar in 2018 and 2022 respectively."^[29] Therefore, the 2026 World Cup could be hosted by one of the remaining four confederations: CONCACAF (North America; last hosted in 1994), CAF (Africa; last hosted in 2010), CONMEBOL (South America; last hosted in 2014), or OFC (Oceania, never hosted before), or potentially by AFC or UEFA in case no bid from the others met the requirements.^[30]

Co-hosting the FIFA World Cup—which had been banned by FIFA after the 2002 World Cup—was approved for the 2026 World Cup, though not limited to a specific number but instead evaluated on a case-by-case basis. Also for 2026, the FIFA general secretariat, after consultation with the Competitions Committee, had the power to exclude bidders who did not meet the minimum technical requirements to host the competition.^[27]

Canada, Mexico, and the United States had each publicly considered bidding for the tournament separately, but the United joint bid was announced on April 10, 2017.^{[31][32]} In March 2022, Liga MX president Mikel Arriola claimed Mexico's involvement as cohost could have been at risk if the league and the federation had not responded quickly to the Querétaro–Atlas riot between rival fans that left 26 spectators injured and resulted in 14 arrests. Arriola said FIFA was "shocked" by the incident but Infantino was satisfied with the sanctions handed down against Querétaro.^[33]

Voting

The voting took place on June 13, 2018, during the 68th FIFA Congress in Moscow, and it was opened to all 203 eligible members.^[34] The United bid won with 134 valid ballots, while the Morocco bid received 65 valid ballots.^{[35][32]} Iran voted for neither of the two bids, while Cuba, Slovenia, and Spain abstained from voting. Ghana was suspended by FIFA due to a corruption scandal and was therefore ineligible to vote.^{[36][37][38][39][40]}



Voting results

Allowed to vote		Ineligible to vote	
	Voted for United bid		Canada–Mexico–United States
	Voted for Moroccan bid		Morocco
	Voted for neither		Sanctioned by FIFA
	Abstained from voting		Not a FIFA member

Voting results

Nation	Vote
	Round 1
Canada, Mexico, United States	134
Morocco	65
None of the bids	1
Abstentions	3
Total votes	200
Required for majority	101

Venues

During the bidding process, 41 cities with 42 existing, fully functional venues with regular tenants (except Montreal) and two venues under construction (Las Vegas and Los Angeles) submitted to be part of the bid (three venues in three cities in Mexico; six venues in six cities in Canada; 35 venues in 32 cities in the United States).^[41] A first-round elimination cut nine venues and nine cities. A second-round elimination cut an additional nine venues in six cities, while three venues in three cities (Chicago, Minneapolis, and Vancouver) dropped out due to FIFA's unwillingness to discuss financial details.^[42] After Montreal dropped out in July 2021 due to lack of provincial funding and support to renovate Olympic Stadium,^[43] Vancouver rejoined the bid as a candidate city in April 2022,^[44] bringing the total number to 24 venues, each in its own city or metropolitan area.^[45]



On June 16, 2022, the sixteen host cities (two in Canada, three in Mexico, eleven in the United States) were announced by FIFA: Atlanta, Boston, Dallas, Guadalajara, Houston, Kansas City, Los Angeles, Mexico City, Miami, Monterrey, New York/New Jersey, Philadelphia, San Francisco Bay Area, Seattle, Toronto, and Vancouver.^[46] Eight of the sixteen chosen stadiums have permanent artificial turf surfaces that are planned to be replaced with grass under the direction of FIFA and a University of Tennessee–Michigan State University research team. Depending on the venue's climate, the turf used is either a hybrid of 84% Kentucky bluegrass and 16% perennial ryegrass (for cooler temperatures), or Bermuda grass (for warmer temperatures).^{[47][48][49]}

Four venues (Atlanta, Dallas, Houston, and Vancouver) are indoor stadiums that use retractable roof systems, all equipped with climate control while a fifth, Los Angeles, is open-air but has a translucent roof and no climate control.^[50] The host of the final match—MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey—was announced by FIFA on February 4, 2024.^[51]

Although there are soccer-specific stadiums in Canada and the United States, the largest dedicated soccer-specific stadium in the United States, Geodis Park in Nashville, Tennessee, seats 30,000, which falls short of FIFA's minimum of 40,000 (Toronto's BMO Field is being expanded from 30,000 to 45,500 for this tournament).^[52] Stadiums including Mercedes-Benz Stadium in Atlanta, Gillette Stadium in Foxborough, Massachusetts, and Lumen Field in Seattle are used by National Football League (NFL) and Major League Soccer (MLS) teams.^[53] Although primarily used for gridiron football, with the American stadiums hosting NFL teams and Canada's hosting the Canadian Football League (CFL), all of the Canadian and American stadiums have been used on numerous occasions for soccer and are also designed to host that sport.^[54]

Mexico City is the only capital of the three host nations chosen as a venue site, with Ottawa and Washington, D.C., joining Bonn (West Germany, 1974) and Tokyo (Japan, 2002) as the only capital cities not selected to host World Cup matches. Washington was a host city candidate, but due to the poor state of Northwest Stadium, it combined its bid with nearby Baltimore's, which was unsuccessful. Other cities eliminated from the final hosting list were Cincinnati, Denver, Nashville, Orlando, and Edmonton. Ottawa's candidate venue, TD Place Stadium, was eliminated early on due to insufficient

capacity.^[55] Though eight of the metropolitan areas hosting games had previously hosted World Cup games (Dallas, Los Angeles, San Francisco Bay Area, New York/New Jersey, and Boston in 1994; Guadalajara and Mexico City in both 1970 and 1986; Monterrey in 1986), Estadio Azteca is the only stadium in this tournament that previously hosted World Cup games, having done so in both 1970 and 1986; none of the stadiums used in the 1994 FIFA World Cup will be used in this tournament.^[56] Soldier Field in Chicago, the Cotton Bowl in Dallas, and the Rose Bowl in Pasadena (Los Angeles area) were the only stadia in the bidding process to have hosted games in 1994, but none of them were selected.^[41]

Due to FIFA's rules on stadium sponsorships, the venues will use alternative names for the duration of the tournament, shown below in parentheses.^{[57][58]} The capacity is based on information published by FIFA.^[58]

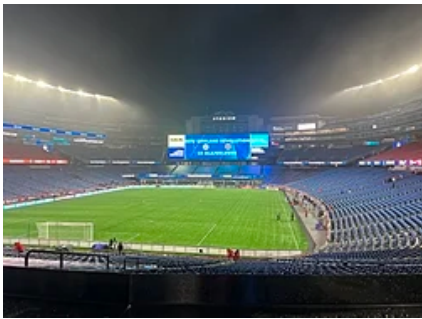
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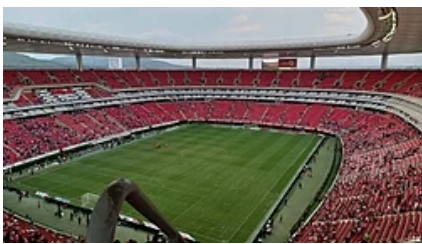
† denotes a stadium used for previous men's World Cup tournaments.

‡ denotes an indoor stadium with a fixed or retractable roof with interior climate control.

List of tournament venues

City	Stadium	Capacity	Image
 Dallas (Arlington, Texas)	<u>AT&T Stadium†</u> (Dallas Stadium)	94,000	
 Mexico City	<u>Estadio Azteca†</u> (Mexico City Stadium)	83,000	
 New York/New Jersey (East Rutherford, New Jersey)	<u>MetLife Stadium</u> (New York New Jersey Stadium)	82,500	
 Atlanta	<u>Mercedes-Benz Stadium†</u> (Atlanta Stadium)	75,000	
 Kansas City	<u>Arrowhead Stadium</u> (Kansas City Stadium)	73,000	

 Houston	NRG Stadium† (Houston Stadium)	72,000	
 San Francisco Bay Area (Santa Clara, California)	Levi's Stadium (San Francisco Bay Area Stadium)	71,000	
 Los Angeles (Inglewood, California)	SoFi Stadium† (Los Angeles Stadium)	70,000	
 Philadelphia	Lincoln Financial Field (Philadelphia Stadium)	69,000	
 Seattle	Lumen Field (Seattle Stadium)	69,000	
 Boston (Foxborough, Massachusetts)	Gillette Stadium (Boston Stadium)	65,000	

 Miami (Miami Gardens, Florida)	<u>Hard Rock Stadium</u> (Miami Stadium)	65,000	
 Vancouver	<u>BC Place†</u> (BC Place Vancouver)	54,000	
 Monterrey (Guadalupe)	<u>Estadio BBVA</u> (Estadio Monterrey)	53,500	
 Guadalajara (Zapopan)	<u>Estadio Akron</u> (Estadio Guadalajara)	48,000	
 Toronto	<u>BMO Field</u> (Toronto Stadium)	45,000	

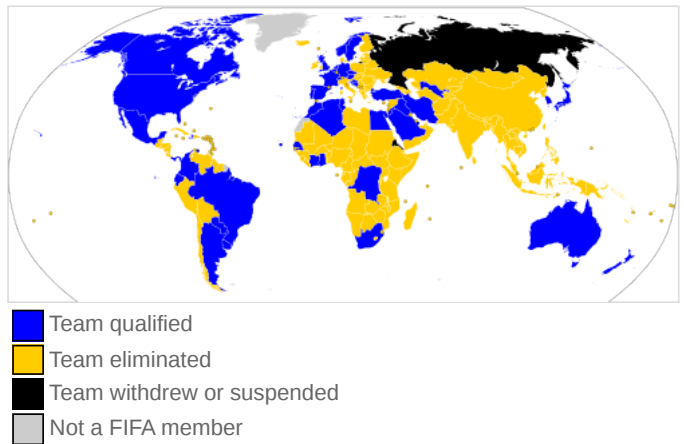
Teams

Qualification

The United Bid personnel anticipated that all three host countries would be awarded automatic berths.^[59] On August 31, 2022, FIFA president Gianni Infantino confirmed that six CONCACAF teams would qualify for the World Cup, with Canada, Mexico, and the United States automatically qualifying as hosts.^{[60][61]} This was confirmed by the FIFA Council on February 14, 2023.^{[62][63]}

Immediately prior to the 67th FIFA Congress, the FIFA Council approved the slot allocation in a meeting in Manama, Bahrain.^{[64][65]} This included an intercontinental playoff tournament involving six teams to decide the last two FIFA World Cup spots.^[66]

The six teams in the playoffs comprised one team from each confederation excluding [UEFA](#), and one additional team from the confederation of the host countries ([CONCACAF](#)). Two of the teams were seeded based on the [World Rankings](#), and they played the winners of two knockout matches between the four unseeded teams for the two [FIFA World Cup](#) berths. The four-match tournament was played in Mexico, one of the host countries, and was also used as a test event for the [FIFA World Cup](#).^[64] The ratification of slot allocation also gave the [OFC](#) a guaranteed berth in the final tournament for the first time: the 2026 [FIFA World Cup](#) will be the first tournament in which all six confederations have at least one guaranteed berth and also the first time since the 2010 edition in which all confederations have a team qualified for the World Cup finals.^[64]



Of the 48 qualified teams, 26 also appeared in the [2022 edition](#). Highlights include:

- [Cape Verde](#),^[67] [Curaçao](#),^{[B][68]} [Jordan](#), and [Uzbekistan](#)^{[C][69]} will all make their World Cup debuts.
- [Qatar](#) advanced to the tournament through qualification for the first time, as its only previous appearance was as host in 2022.^[70]
- [DR Congo](#)^[D] and [Haiti](#) return to the tournament after appearing in their only previous tournament in 1974.^{[68][71]}
- [Iraq](#) returns to the tournament after appearing in its only previous tournament in 1986.^[72]
- [Austria](#), [Norway](#),^[73] and [Scotland](#) return to the tournament after last appearing in 1998.^[74]
- [Turkey](#) qualified for the first time since finishing third in 2002.^[75]
- [Czech Republic](#)^[E] qualified for the first time since 2006.^[76]
- [New Zealand](#), [Paraguay](#), and [South Africa](#) (2010 World Cup host) return after last taking part in 2010.^[77] South Africa achieved its first successful qualifying campaign since 2002 while New Zealand is the lowest ranked team to qualify, ranked 85th.^[78]
- [Algeria](#), [Bosnia and Herzegovina](#), and [Ivory Coast](#) qualified for the first time since 2014. Bosnia achieved its first successful qualification process for a major tournament since the 2014 World Cup.
- [Colombia](#), [Egypt](#), [Panama](#), and [Sweden](#) return after missing the previous tournament in 2022.

Additionally, four-time champion [Italy](#) missed out after being defeated in the [European playoff final](#) by Bosnia and Herzegovina on [penalties](#), becoming the first former champion to miss out on three consecutive World Cups.^[79] Similar to 2018 and 2022, Italy was the only former champion that did not qualify. [Costa Rica](#) failed to qualify for the first time since 2010, while [Cameroon](#), [Denmark](#), [Poland](#), [Serbia](#), and [Wales](#), all of whom qualified in 2022, also did not qualify for the 2026 tournament.^[80]

The teams that qualified, sorted by region:

[AFC](#) (9)

-  [Australia](#)
-  [Iran](#)^[F]
-  [Iraq](#)
-  [Japan](#)
-  [Jordan](#) (debut)
-  [Qatar](#)
-  [Saudi Arabia](#)
-  [South Korea](#)^[G]
-  [Uzbekistan](#) (debut)

[CAF](#) (10)

-  [Algeria](#)

-  [Cape Verde^{\[H\]}](#) (debut)
-  [DR Congo^{\[I\]}](#)
-  [Egypt](#)
-  [Ghana](#)
-  [Ivory Coast^{\[J\]}](#)
-  [Morocco](#)
-  [Senegal](#)
-  [South Africa](#)
-  [Tunisia](#)

CONCACAF (6)

-  [Canada](#) (co-host)
-  [Curaçao](#) (debut)
-  [Haiti](#)
-  [Mexico](#) (co-host)
-  [Panama](#)
-  [United States^{\[K\]}](#) (co-host)

CONMEBOL (6)

-  [Argentina](#)
-  [Brazil](#)
-  [Colombia](#)
-  [Ecuador](#)
-  [Paraguay](#)
-  [Uruguay](#)

OFC (1)

-  [New Zealand](#)

UEFA (16)

-  [Austria](#)
-  [Belgium](#)
-  [Bosnia and Herzegovina](#)
-  [Croatia](#)
-  [Czech Republic^{\[L\]}](#)
-  [England](#)
-  [France](#)
-  [Germany](#)
-  [Netherlands](#)
-  [Norway](#)
-  [Portugal](#)
-  [Scotland](#)
-  [Spain](#)
-  [Sweden](#)
-  [Switzerland](#)
-  [Turkey^{\[M\]}](#)

Draw

The draw took place on December 5, 2025, at the [Kennedy Center](#) in [Washington, D.C.](#)^[81] The draw ceremony began with FIFA presenting the first (and as of 2026 the only) FIFA Peace Prize to United States president Donald Trump,^[82] an award which fueled scrutiny and controversy among human rights groups, analysts, and others.^{[83][84][85][86]}

The 48 teams were divided into four pots of 12. Pot 1 consisted of the three hosts and the top nine teams from the November 2025 [FIFA Men's World Ranking](#). Pots 2, 3, and 4 consisted of the remaining teams according to the ranking. The four winners of the [UEFA playoffs](#) and the two winners of the [inter-confederation playoffs](#) were not known at the time of the draw and thus were automatically allocated to Pot 4. The 12 groups were randomly formed by selecting one team from each of the four pots. FIFA's "general principle, whenever possible", was that no group had more than one team from the same confederation drawn into it.^{[87][88]} This principle was applicable to all confederations except UEFA; each group was required to have either one or two UEFA teams drawn into it.

The three host nations were pre-allocated to three groups for scheduling purposes. Mexico was placed in Group A and will play the opening match of the tournament at [Estadio Azteca](#) on June 11. Canada and the United States were placed in Groups B and D, respectively. They will play the third and fourth matches of the tournament, respectively, both on June 12.^{[2][89]}

The confederation restriction applied to all three potential winners of the inter-confederation playoffs. FIFA also announced that, "in the interest of ensuring competitive balance", two separate pathways to the semifinals (sides of the knockout bracket) were established. Based on this, the teams ranked first (Spain) and second (Argentina) in the ranking were randomly drawn into groups in opposite pathways, as were the teams ranked third (France) and fourth (England). Therefore, should these pairs of teams win their groups, they will be unable to meet until the final, while all four will be unable to meet until the semifinals.^[90] The draw started with Pot 1 and ended with Pot 4, with each team selected then allocated into the first available group alphabetically. For the purpose of the match schedule, the Pot 1 teams were automatically drawn into position 1 of each group. For the remaining pots, FIFA established a predetermined pattern to define the position of teams based on their pot and the group they were drawn into.

Pots^[N]

Pot 1	Pot 2	Pot 3	Pot 4
United States (<i>co-host</i>) (14) Mexico (<i>co-host</i>) (15) Canada (<i>co-host</i>) (27) Spain (1) Argentina (2) France (3) England (4) Brazil (5) Portugal (6) Netherlands (7) Belgium (8) Germany (9)	Croatia (10) Morocco (11) Colombia (13) Uruguay (16) Switzerland (17) Japan (18) Senegal (19) Iran (20) South Korea (22) Ecuador (23) Austria (24) Australia (26)	Norway (29) Panama (30) Egypt (34) Algeria (35) Scotland (36) Paraguay (39) Tunisia (40) Ivory Coast (42) Uzbekistan (50) Qatar (51) Saudi Arabia (60) South Africa (61)	Jordan (66) Cape Verde (68) Ghana (72) Curaçao (82) Haiti (84) New Zealand (86) UEFA Path A winners^[O] UEFA Path B winners^[O] UEFA Path C winners^[O] UEFA Path D winners^[O] IC Path 1 winners^{[O][P]} IC Path 2 winners^{[O][Q]}

Team base camps

Base camps will be used by the 48 national squads to stay and train before and during the World Cup tournament.^{[92][93][94][95]}

Similar to the prohibition of naming-rights sponsors that apply to the competition venues, the names of some training facilities were also altered by FIFA.^[96]

List of team base camps

Team	Hotel	Training site
 Algeria^[97]	The Oread Lawrence, Lawrence, Kansas	University of Kansas,^[98] Lawrence, Kansas
 Argentina^[99]	Origin Kansas City Riverfront, Kansas City, Missouri	Sporting KC Training Center, Kansas City, Kansas
 Australia^[100]	Claremont Hotel & Spa, Berkeley, California	Oakland Roots/Soul Training Facility, Alameda, California
 Austria^[101]	Bacara Resort, Goleta, California	UC Santa Barbara Harder Stadium, Santa Barbara, California
 Belgium^[102]	Hyatt Regency Lake Washington at Seattle's Southport, Renton, Washington	Seattle Sounders FC Performance Center and Clubhouse, Renton, Washington
 Bosnia and Herzegovina^[103]	Asher Adams, Autograph Collection, Salt Lake City, Utah	Real Salt Lake Stadium, Sandy, Utah
 Brazil^[104]	The Ridge, Basking Ridge, New Jersey	Columbia Park, Morristown, New Jersey
 Canada^[105]	The Westin Bayshore, Vancouver, British Columbia	National Soccer Development Centre, Vancouver, British Columbia
 Cape Verde^[106]	Grand Hyatt Tampa Bay, Tampa, Florida	Waters Sportsplex, Tampa, Florida
 Colombia^[107]	Grand Fiesta Americana Country Club, Guadalajara, Jalisco	Academia Atlas FC, Zapopan, Jalisco
 Croatia^[108]	Hotel AKA Alexandria, Alexandria, Virginia	Episcopal High School, Alexandria, Virginia
 Curaçao^[109]	Boca Raton Marriott at Boca Center, Boca Raton, Florida	Florida Atlantic University, Boca Raton, Florida
 Czech Republic^[110]	Hilton Garden Inn Dallas-Arlington South, Arlington, Texas	Mansfield Multipurpose Stadium, Mansfield, Texas
 DR Congo^[111]	Omni Houston Hotel, Houston, Texas	Houston Sports Park, Houston, Texas
 Ecuador^[112]	Le Méridien Columbus, The Joseph, Columbus, Ohio	Columbus Crew Performance Center, Columbus, Ohio
 Egypt^[113]	Northern Quest Resort & Casino, Airway Heights, Washington	Gonzaga University, Spokane, Washington
 England^[97]	The Inn at Meadowbrook, Prairie Village, Kansas	Swope Soccer Village, Kansas City, Missouri
 France^[114]	Four Seasons Hotel Boston, Boston, Massachusetts	Bentley University, Waltham, Massachusetts
 Germany^[115]	Graylyn, Winston-Salem, North Carolina	Wake Forest University, Winston-Salem, North Carolina
 Ghana^[116]	Providence Biltmore, Providence, Rhode Island	Bryant University, Smithfield, Rhode Island
 Haiti^[117]	Sheraton Atlantic City Convention Center Hotel, Atlantic City, New Jersey	Stockton University, Galloway Township, New Jersey
 Iran^[118]	Tijuana Marriott Hotel, Tijuana, Baja California	Club Tijuana Training Center, Tijuana, Baja California
 Iraq^[106]	Greenbrier Resort, White Sulphur Springs, West Virginia	The Greenbrier Sports Performance Centre, White Sulphur Springs, West Virginia
 Ivory Coast^[119]	Hotel Du Pont, Wilmington, Delaware	Philadelphia Union Stadium, Chester, Pennsylvania
 Japan^[120]	TBA, Nashville, Tennessee	Nashville SC Training Center, Nashville, Tennessee
 Jordan^[121]	The Nines Hotel, Portland, Oregon	University of Portland, Portland, Oregon
 Mexico^[122]	Centro de Alto Rendimiento on-site accommodation, Mexico City	Centro de Alto Rendimiento, Mexico City
 Morocco^[123]	Somerset Hills Hotel, Tapestry Collection by Hilton, Warren, New Jersey	Pingry School, Basking Ridge, New Jersey
 Netherlands^[124]	Cascade Hotel, Kansas City, a Tribute Portfolio Hotel, Kansas City, Missouri	Kansas City Current Training Facility, Riverside, Missouri
 New Zealand^[125]	Hyatt Regency La Jolla at Aventine, San Diego, California	Torero Stadium, San Diego, California

 Norway ^[126]	Grandover Resort & Spa, A Wyndham Grand Hotel, Greensboro, North Carolina	University of North Carolina at Greensboro, Greensboro, North Carolina
 Panama ^[127]	Nottawasaga Inn Resort & Conference Centre, New Tecumseth, Ontario	Nottawasaga Training Site, New Tecumseth, Ontario
 Paraguay ^[128]	Signia by Hilton San Jose, San Jose, California	Spartan Soccer Complex, San Jose, California
 Portugal ^[129]	Four Seasons Hotel Palm Beach, Palm Beach, Florida	Gardens North County District Park, Palm Beach Gardens, Florida
 Qatar ^[130]	Courtyard by Marriott Santa Barbara Goleta, Goleta, California	Westmont College, Santa Barbara, California
 Saudi Arabia ^[131]	Four Seasons Hotel Austin, Austin, Texas	Austin FC Stadium, Austin, Texas
 Scotland ^[132]	Renaissance Charlotte SouthPark Hotel, Charlotte, North Carolina	Charlotte FC Training Center, Charlotte, North Carolina
 Senegal ^[133]	The Heldrich Hotel and Conference Center, New Brunswick, New Jersey	Rutgers University, Piscataway, New Jersey
 South Africa ^[122]	Camino Real Pachuca, Pachuca, Hidalgo	Universidad Del Futbol, San Agustín Tlaxiaca, Hidalgo
 South Korea ^[134]	The Westin Guadalajara, Guadalajara, Jalisco	Chivas Verde Valle, Zapopan, Jalisco
 Spain ^[135]	The Read House Hotel, Chattanooga, Tennessee	Baylor School, Chattanooga, Tennessee
 Sweden ^[110]	The Westin Dallas Stonebriar Golf Resort & Spa, Frisco, Texas	FC Dallas Stadium, Frisco, Texas
 Switzerland ^[136]	Fairmont Grand Del Mar, San Diego, California	San Diego Jewish Academy, San Diego, California
 Tunisia ^[122]	InterContinental Presidente Monterrey, San Pedro Garza García, Nuevo León	Rayados Training Center, Santiago, Nuevo León
 Turkey ^[137]	Courtyard Mesa at Wrigleyville West, Mesa, Arizona	Arizona Athletic Grounds, Mesa, Arizona
 United States ^[138]	Marriott Irvine Spectrum, Irvine, California	Orange County Great Park, Irvine, California
 Uruguay ^[139]	Fairmont Mayakoba, Playa del Carmen, Quintana Roo	Mayakoba Training Centre, Playa del Carmen, Quintana Roo
 Uzbekistan ^[140]	JW Marriott Atlanta Buckhead, Atlanta, Georgia	Atlanta United Training Center, Marietta, Georgia

Squads

Before submitting their final squad for the tournament, teams named a provisional squad of between 35 and 55 players one month prior to the tournament. Teams were required to name their final squads by June 2. If a player becomes injured or severely ill to prevent his participation in the tournament, he can be replaced by another player from the provisional squad until 24 hours before the team's first match. However, an injured or ill goalkeeper may be replaced by another goalkeeper from the provisional squad at any time during the tournament.^[141]

Officiating

On April 9, 2026, FIFA announced the list of 52 referees, 88 assistant referees, and 30 [video assistant referees](#) for the tournament.^{[142][143]}

Opening ceremonies

The tournament is set to feature three opening ceremonies, one for each of the hosts. The opening ceremony in Mexico will take place on June 11, 2026, at Estadio Banorte and feature Mexican rock band [Maná](#), Mexican singers [Alejandro Fernández](#), [Belinda](#), and [Lila Downs](#), Mexican cumbia band [Los Ángeles Azules](#), South African singer [Tyla](#), Nigerian singer [Burna Boy](#), Colombian singers [J Balvin](#) and [Shakira](#), and Venezuelan singer [Danny Ocean](#). The opening ceremony in Canada will take place on June 12, 2026, at BMO Field in Toronto and feature performances by Canadian singers [Alanis Morissette](#), [Alessia Cara](#), [Jessie Reyez](#), [Michael Bublé](#), [Nora Fatehi](#), and [William Prince](#), Palestinian singer [Elyanna](#), Bangladeshi-American DJ

Sanjoy, and French singer [Vegedream](#). On the same day, the opening ceremony for the United States will take place at SoFi Stadium in Los Angeles and feature performances by American singer [Katy Perry](#), American rapper [Future](#), Thai rapper and [Blackpink](#) member [Lisa](#), Brazilian singer [Anitta](#), Nigerian singer [Rema](#), and South African singer Tyla.^{[144][145][146]}

In the days leading up to the tournament, a countdown concert will take place in the same cities on June 10. The Toronto concert at [Fort York](#) and [The Bentway](#) is set to feature performances by Canadian singers [Bryan Adams](#) and [Nora Fatehi](#), Bangladeshi-American DJ [Sanjoy](#), French singer [Vegedream](#), and a special collaboration between Canadian singer [AHI](#) and Haitian rapper [Wyclef Jean](#). The Mexico City concert at [Auditorio Nacional](#) is set to feature performances by Mexican cumbia band [Los Ángeles Azules](#), Mexican singer [Belinda](#), Venezuelan-American singer [Elena Rose](#), and a surprise guest. The Los Angeles concert at [Crypto.com Arena](#) is set to feature performances by American electronic music group [Major Lazer](#), Nigerian-American singer [Davido](#), and more special guests.^{[147][148][149]}

In addition, two special ceremonies will take place on July 4, 2026, to honor the [United States Semiquincentennial](#) at Lincoln Financial Field in Philadelphia and [NRG Stadium](#) in Houston.^[150]

Match schedule

The match schedule, without group assignments, was announced on February 4, 2024.^{[2][151][152]} On June 13, 2024, FIFA released an updated schedule, with specific pairings assigned to venues for the knockout stage.^[153] In addition, group stage matches were assigned to specific groups (though pairings for non-host groups were not assigned to specific matches until after the final draw; thus the group venues were known, but not for which specific pairing each matchday). The full schedule was unveiled in a live broadcast on December 6, 2025, the day after the draw. Group stage pairings were allocated to specific matches, and the kickoff times were confirmed for all fixtures.^[154]

The opening match was announced to include Mexico, taking place on June 11, 2026, at the [Estadio Azteca](#) in [Mexico City](#). This match will include South Africa.^[155] The opening match involving Canada will take place on June 12 at [BMO Field](#) in [Toronto](#), while the opening match for the United States will take place on the same day at [SoFi Stadium](#) in [Inglewood](#). Each host nation is scheduled to play its three matches in the group stage within its own country.^[151]

[AT&T Stadium](#) in [Arlington, Texas](#), will host the most matches of any venue at the tournament with nine. [MetLife Stadium](#) in [East Rutherford, New Jersey](#), will host the final on July 19. The United States will host 78 matches, including from the quarterfinal stage onward, while Canada and Mexico will each host 13. Each tournament venue, except for the [Estadio Akron](#), will host at least one knockout stage fixture.^[156] The match schedule will overlap with the 2026 CFL season, resulting in scheduling conflicts and loss of home games for the [Toronto Argonauts](#) and [BC Lions](#).^{[157][158]} The match schedule will also affect the 2026 Major League Baseball season schedules of the [Kansas City Royals](#), [Philadelphia Phillies](#), [Seattle Mariners](#), and [Texas Rangers](#), whose home stadiums are located near World Cup venues.^[159]

Host cities were geographically grouped into three regions:^[2]

- Western Region ([Vancouver](#), [Seattle](#), [San Francisco Bay Area](#), [Los Angeles](#))
- Central Region ([Guadalajara](#), [Mexico City](#), [Monterrey](#), [Houston](#), [Dallas](#), [Kansas City](#))
- Eastern Region ([Atlanta](#), [Miami](#), [Toronto](#), [Boston](#), [Philadelphia](#), [New York/New Jersey](#))

Schedule by round

Round	Matchday	Date
Group stage	Matchday 1	June 11–17, 2026
	Matchday 2	June 18–23, 2026
	Matchday 3	June 24–27, 2026
Knockout stage	Round of 32	June 28 – July 3, 2026
	Round of 16	July 4–7, 2026
	Quarterfinals	July 9–11, 2026
	Semifinals	July 14–15, 2026
	Match for third place	July 18, 2026
	Final	July 19, 2026

Schedule by group

Matchday	Pairings	Groups	Date
Matchday 1	1 vs 2 3 vs 4	A	June 11, 2026
		B & D	June 12, 2026
		B, C & D	June 13, 2026
		E & F	June 14, 2026
		G & H	June 15, 2026
		I & J	June 16, 2026
Matchday 2	1 vs 3 4 vs 2	K & L	June 17, 2026
		A & B	June 18, 2026
		C & D	June 19, 2026
		E & F	June 20, 2026
		G & H	June 21, 2026
		I & J	June 22, 2026
Matchday 3	4 vs 1 2 vs 3	K & L	June 23, 2026
		A, B & C	June 24, 2026
		D, E & F	June 25, 2026
		G, H & I	June 26, 2026
		J, K & L	June 27, 2026

Group stage

The group stage will be played from June 11 to 27.^[160] Competing countries were divided into twelve groups of four teams (groups A to L), with teams in each group playing one another in a round-robin. In the group standings, three points are awarded for a win, one for a draw, and none for a loss. Following the conclusion of group play, the top two teams of each group, along with the eight best third-placed teams across all groups, will advance to the knockout stage.

All times are local.

Tie-breaking criteria for group stage ranking

The ranking of teams in each group is determined by the points obtained in all group matches. If two or more teams are equal on points, the following criteria are used to determine the ranking:^[161]

- Most points obtained in the group matches played between the teams concerned;
- Superior goal difference in the group matches played between the teams concerned;
- Most goals scored in the group matches played between the teams concerned;

If, after having applied criteria a to c, teams still had an equal ranking, criteria a to c are reapplied exclusively to the matches between the teams who are still level to determine their final rankings. If this procedure does not lead to a decision, criteria d to h apply.

- Superior goal difference in all group matches;
- Most goals scored in all group matches;
- Highest team conduct ("fair play") score in all group matches (only one deduction can be applied to a player or team coach/official in a single match):
 - Yellow card: −1 point;
 - Indirect red card (second yellow card): −3 points;
 - Direct red card: −4 points;
 - Yellow card and direct red card: −5 points;
- Better position in the most recent FIFA Men's World Ranking;
- Better position in progressively older FIFA Men's World Rankings until teams can be separated.

Group A

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Mexico (H)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 South Africa	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 South Korea	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible <u>knockout stage</u> based on <u>ranking</u>
4	 Czech Republic	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 11, 2026. Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

(H) Hosts

June 11, 2026

1:00 p.m. UTC-6

Mexico 

Match 1

 South Africa

[\[Report 1\]](#)

Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

June 11, 2026

8:00 p.m. UTC-6

South Korea 

Match 2

 Czech Republic

[\[Report 2\]](#)

Estadio Akron, Zapopan

June 18, 2026

12:00 p.m. UTC-4

Czech Republic 

Match 25

 South Africa

[\[Report 3\]](#)

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

June 18, 2026

7:00 p.m. UTC-6

Mexico 

Match 28

 South Korea

[\[Report 4\]](#)

Estadio Akron, Zapopan

June 24, 2026

7:00 p.m. UTC-6

Czech Republic 

Match 53

 Mexico

[\[Report 5\]](#)

Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

June 24, 2026

7:00 p.m. UTC-6

South Africa 

Match 54

 South Korea

[\[Report 6\]](#)

Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe

Group B

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 <u>Canada</u> (H)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 <u>Bosnia and Herzegovina</u>	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 <u>Qatar</u>	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible <u>knockout stage</u> based on <u>ranking</u>
4	 <u>Switzerland</u>	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 12, 2026. Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)
(H) Hosts

June 12, 2026
3:00 p.m. UTC-4

Canada  Match 3  Bosnia and Herzegovina
[Report 7]

BMO Field, Toronto

June 13, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Qatar  Match 8  Switzerland
[Report 8]

Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

June 18, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Switzerland  Match 26  Bosnia and Herzegovina
[Report 9]

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood

June 18, 2026
3:00 p.m. UTC-7

Canada  Match 27  Qatar
[Report 10]

BC Place, Vancouver

June 24, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Switzerland  Match 51  Canada
[Report 11]

BC Place, Vancouver

June 24, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Bosnia and Herzegovina  Match 52  Qatar
[Report 12]

Lumen Field, Seattle

Group C

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Brazil	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Morocco	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Haiti	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible <u>knockout stage</u> based on <u>ranking</u>
4	 Scotland	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 13, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

June 13, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Brazil 

Match 7

[\[Report 13\]](#)

 Morocco

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford

June 13, 2026

9:00 p.m. UTC-4

Haiti 

Match 5

[\[Report 14\]](#)

 Scotland

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough

June 19, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Scotland 

Match 30

[\[Report 15\]](#)

 Morocco

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough

June 19, 2026

8:30 p.m. UTC-4

Brazil 

Match 29

[\[Report 16\]](#)

 Haiti

Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia

June 24, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Scotland 

Match 49

[\[Report 17\]](#)

 Brazil

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

June 24, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Morocco 

Match 50

[\[Report 18\]](#)

 Haiti

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Group D

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 United States (H)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Paraguay	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Australia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 Turkey	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 12, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

(H) Hosts

June 12, 2026

6:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[United States](#) 

[Match 4](#)

[\[Report 19\]](#)

 [Paraguay](#)

[SoFi Stadium, Inglewood](#)

June 13, 2026

9:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Australia](#) 

[Match 6](#)

[\[Report 20\]](#)

 [Turkey](#)

[BC Place, Vancouver](#)

June 19, 2026

12:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[United States](#) 

[Match 32](#)

[\[Report 21\]](#)

 [Australia](#)

[Lumen Field, Seattle](#)

June 19, 2026

8:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Turkey](#) 

[Match 31](#)

[\[Report 22\]](#)

 [Paraguay](#)

[Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara](#)

June 25, 2026

7:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Turkey](#) 

[Match 59](#)

[\[Report 23\]](#)

 [United States](#)

[SoFi Stadium, Inglewood](#)

June 25, 2026

7:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Paraguay](#) 

[Match 60](#)

[\[Report 24\]](#)

 [Australia](#)

[Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara](#)

Group E

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Germany	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Curaçao	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Ivory Coast	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 Ecuador	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 14, 2026. Source: [FIFA](#) (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 14, 2026
12:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

[Germany](#) 

[Match 10](#)
[\[Report 25\]](#)

 [Curaçao](#)

[NRG Stadium, Houston](#)

June 14, 2026
7:00 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

[Ivory Coast](#) 

[Match 9](#)
[\[Report 26\]](#)

 [Ecuador](#)

[Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia](#)

June 20, 2026
4:00 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

[Germany](#) 

[Match 33](#)
[\[Report 27\]](#)

 [Ivory Coast](#)

[BMO Field, Toronto](#)

June 20, 2026
7:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

[Ecuador](#) 

[Match 34](#)
[\[Report 28\]](#)

 [Curaçao](#)

[Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City](#)

June 25, 2026
4:00 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

[Curaçao](#) 

[Match 55](#)
[\[Report 29\]](#)

 [Ivory Coast](#)

[Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia](#)

June 25, 2026
4:00 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

[Ecuador](#) 

[Match 56](#)
[\[Report 30\]](#)

 [Germany](#)

[MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford](#)

Group F

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Netherlands	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Japan	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Sweden	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 Tunisia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 14, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

June 14, 2026

3:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

[Netherlands](#) 

Match 11

 [Japan](#)

[\[Report 31\]](#)

[AT&T Stadium, Arlington](#)

June 14, 2026

8:00 p.m. [UTC-6](#)

[Sweden](#) 

Match 12

 [Tunisia](#)

[\[Report 32\]](#)

[Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe](#)

June 20, 2026

12:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

[Netherlands](#) 

Match 35

 [Sweden](#)

[\[Report 33\]](#)

[NRG Stadium, Houston](#)

June 20, 2026

10:00 p.m. [UTC-6](#)

[Tunisia](#) 

Match 36

 [Japan](#)

[\[Report 34\]](#)

[Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe](#)

June 25, 2026

6:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

[Japan](#) 

Match 57

 [Sweden](#)

[\[Report 35\]](#)

[AT&T Stadium, Arlington](#)

June 25, 2026

6:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

[Tunisia](#) 

Match 58

 [Netherlands](#)

[\[Report 36\]](#)

[Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City](#)

Group G

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Belgium	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Egypt	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Iran	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 New Zealand	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 15, 2026. Source: [FIFA](#) (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 15, 2026
12:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Belgium](#) 

[Match 16](#)
[\[Report 37\]](#)

 [Egypt](#)

[Lumen Field, Seattle](#)

June 15, 2026
6:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Iran](#) 

[Match 15](#)
[\[Report 38\]](#)

 [New Zealand](#)

[SoFi Stadium, Inglewood](#)

June 21, 2026
12:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Belgium](#) 

[Match 39](#)
[\[Report 39\]](#)

 [Iran](#)

[SoFi Stadium, Inglewood](#)

June 21, 2026
6:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[New Zealand](#) 

[Match 40](#)
[\[Report 40\]](#)

 [Egypt](#)

[BC Place, Vancouver](#)

June 26, 2026
8:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[Egypt](#) 

[Match 63](#)
[\[Report 41\]](#)

 [Iran](#)

[Lumen Field, Seattle](#)

June 26, 2026
8:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

[New Zealand](#) 

[Match 64](#)
[\[Report 42\]](#)

 [Belgium](#)

[BC Place, Vancouver](#)

Group H

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Spain	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Cape Verde	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Saudi Arabia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible <u>knockout stage</u> based on <u>ranking</u>
4	 Uruguay	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 15, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

June 15, 2026

12:00 p.m. UTC-4

Spain 

Match 14

[\[Report 43\]](#)

 Cape Verde

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

June 15, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Saudi Arabia 

Match 13

[\[Report 44\]](#)

 Uruguay

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

June 21, 2026

12:00 p.m. UTC-4

Spain 

Match 38

[\[Report 45\]](#)

 Saudi Arabia

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

June 21, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Uruguay 

Match 37

[\[Report 46\]](#)

 Cape Verde

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

June 26, 2026

7:00 p.m. UTC-5

Cape Verde 

Match 65

[\[Report 47\]](#)

 Saudi Arabia

NRG Stadium, Houston

June 26, 2026

6:00 p.m. UTC-6

Uruguay 

Match 66

[\[Report 48\]](#)

 Spain

Estadio Akron, Zapopan

Group I

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 France	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Senegal	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Iraq	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 Norway	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 16, 2026. Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 16, 2026

3:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[France](#) 

[Match 17](#)

[\[Report 49\]](#)

 [Senegal](#)

[MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford](#)

June 16, 2026

6:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Iraq](#) 

[Match 18](#)

[\[Report 50\]](#)

 [Norway](#)

[Gillette Stadium, Foxborough](#)

June 22, 2026

5:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[France](#) 

[Match 42](#)

[\[Report 51\]](#)

 [Iraq](#)

[Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia](#)

June 22, 2026

8:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Norway](#) 

[Match 41](#)

[\[Report 52\]](#)

 [Senegal](#)

[MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford](#)

June 26, 2026

3:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Norway](#) 

[Match 61](#)

[\[Report 53\]](#)

 [France](#)

[Gillette Stadium, Foxborough](#)

June 26, 2026

3:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Senegal](#) 

[Match 62](#)

[\[Report 54\]](#)

 [Iraq](#)

[BMO Field, Toronto](#)

Group J

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Argentina	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Algeria	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Austria	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 Jordan	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 16, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

June 16, 2026

8:00 p.m. [UTC−5](#)

[Argentina](#) 

Match 19

[\[Report 55\]](#)

 [Algeria](#)

[Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City](#)

June 16, 2026

9:00 p.m. [UTC−7](#)

[Austria](#) 

Match 20

[\[Report 56\]](#)

 [Jordan](#)

[Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara](#)

June 22, 2026

12:00 p.m. [UTC−5](#)

[Argentina](#) 

Match 43

[\[Report 57\]](#)

 [Austria](#)

[AT&T Stadium, Arlington](#)

June 22, 2026

8:00 p.m. [UTC−7](#)

[Jordan](#) 

Match 44

[\[Report 58\]](#)

 [Algeria](#)

[Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara](#)

June 27, 2026

9:00 p.m. [UTC−5](#)

[Algeria](#) 

Match 69

[\[Report 59\]](#)

 [Austria](#)

[Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City](#)

June 27, 2026

9:00 p.m. [UTC−5](#)

[Jordan](#) 

Match 70

[\[Report 60\]](#)

 [Argentina](#)

[AT&T Stadium, Arlington](#)

Group K

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Portugal	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 DR Congo	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Uzbekistan	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible <u>knockout stage</u> based on <u>ranking</u>
4	 Colombia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 17, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

June 17, 2026

12:00 p.m. UTC-5

Portugal 

Match 23
[\[Report 61\]](#)

 DR Congo

NRG Stadium, Houston

June 17, 2026

8:00 p.m. UTC-6

Uzbekistan 

Match 24
[\[Report 62\]](#)

 Colombia

Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

June 23, 2026

12:00 p.m. UTC-5

Portugal 

Match 47
[\[Report 63\]](#)

 Uzbekistan

NRG Stadium, Houston

June 23, 2026

8:00 p.m. UTC-6

Colombia 

Match 48
[\[Report 64\]](#)

 DR Congo

Estadio Akron, Zapopan

June 27, 2026

7:30 p.m. UTC-4

Colombia 

Match 71
[\[Report 65\]](#)

 Portugal

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

June 27, 2026

7:30 p.m. UTC-4

DR Congo 

Match 72
[\[Report 66\]](#)

 Uzbekistan

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Group L

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 England	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	 Croatia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	 Ghana	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Possible knockout stage based on ranking
4	 Panama	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 17, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

June 17, 2026

3:00 p.m. [UTC−5](#)

[England](#) 

[Match 22](#)

[\[Report 67\]](#)

 [Croatia](#)

[AT&T Stadium, Arlington](#)

June 17, 2026

7:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Ghana](#) 

[Match 21](#)

[\[Report 68\]](#)

 [Panama](#)

[Toronto Stadium, Toronto](#)

June 23, 2026

4:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[England](#) 

[Match 45](#)

[\[Report 69\]](#)

 [Ghana](#)

[Gillette Stadium, Foxborough](#)

June 23, 2026

7:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Panama](#) 

[Match 46](#)

[\[Report 70\]](#)

 [Croatia](#)

[Toronto Stadium, Toronto](#)

June 27, 2026

5:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Panama](#) 

[Match 67](#)

[\[Report 71\]](#)

 [England](#)

[MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford](#)

June 27, 2026

5:00 p.m. [UTC−4](#)

[Croatia](#) 

[Match 68](#)

[\[Report 72\]](#)

 [Ghana](#)

[Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia](#)

Ranking of third-placed teams

Pos	Grp	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	A	Third place Group A	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	Advance to knockout stage
2	B	Third place Group B	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
3	C	Third place Group C	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
4	D	Third place Group D	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
5	E	Third place Group E	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
6	F	Third place Group F	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
7	G	Third place Group G	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
8	H	Third place Group H	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
9	I	Third place Group I	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
10	J	Third place Group J	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
11	K	Third place Group K	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	
12	L	Third place Group L	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	

First match(es) will be played: June 11, 2026. Source: [FIFA \(https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings\)](https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings)

Rules for classification: 1) Points; 2) Goal difference; 3) Goals scored; 4) Team conduct score; 5) Latest [FIFA ranking](#); 6) Previous FIFA ranking(s).

The specific match-ups involving the third-placed teams depend on which eight third-placed teams qualify for the round of 32. The 495 possible combinations were published in Annex C of the tournament regulations.^[161]

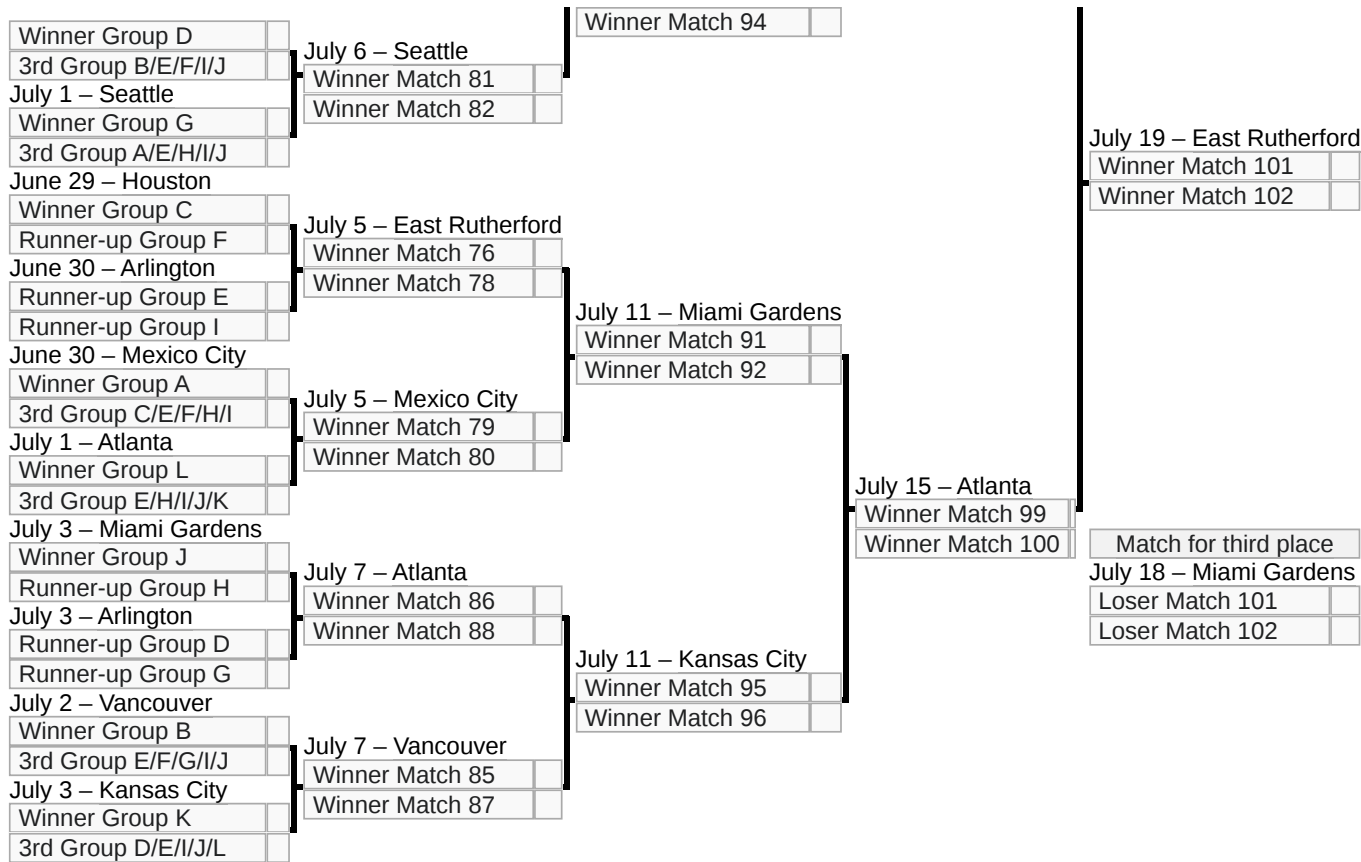
For the list of all 495 possible combinations, see [2026 FIFA World Cup knockout stage § Combinations of matches in the round of 32](#).

Knockout stage

The knockout stage will be played in a [single-elimination](#) format, starting with the round of 32 on June 28 and culminating with the [final](#) on July 19. On the day prior, a match for [third place](#) will also be played between the two losing teams of the semi-finals to determine the bronze medalists. In the knockout stage, if the scores are level when normal playing time expires, 30 minutes of [extra time](#) will be played. If still tied at the end of extra time, a [penalty shootout](#) will be used to determine the winner.^[161]

Bracket





Round of 32

June 28, 2026

12:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

Runner-up Group A

Match 73

Runner-up Group B

[\[Report 73\]](#)

[SoFi Stadium, Inglewood](#)

June 29, 2026

12:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

Winner Group C

Match 76

Runner-up Group F

[\[Report 74\]](#)

[NRG Stadium, Houston](#)

June 29, 2026

4:30 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

Winner Group E

Match 74

3rd Group A/B/C/D/F

[\[Report 75\]](#)

[Gillette Stadium, Foxborough](#)

June 29, 2026

7:00 p.m. [UTC-6](#)

Winner Group F

Match 75

Runner-up Group C

[\[Report 76\]](#)

[Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe](#)

June 30, 2026

12:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

Runner-up Group E

Match 78

Runner-up Group I

[\[Report 77\]](#)

AT&T Stadium, Arlington

June 30, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-4

Winner Group I

Match 77
[Report 78]

3rd Group C/D/F/G/H

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford

June 30, 2026
7:00 p.m. UTC-6

Winner Group A

Match 79
[Report 79]

3rd Group C/E/F/H/I

Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

July 1, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-4

Winner Group L

Match 80
[Report 80]

3rd Group E/H/I/J/K

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

July 1, 2026
1:00 p.m. UTC-7

Winner Group G

Match 82
[Report 81]

3rd Group A/E/H/I/J

Lumen Field, Seattle

July 1, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-7

Winner Group D

Match 81
[Report 82]

3rd Group B/E/F/I/J

Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

July 2, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Winner Group H

Match 84
[Report 83]

Runner-up Group J

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood

July 2, 2026
7:00 p.m. UTC-4

Runner-up Group K

Match 83
[Report 84]

Runner-up Group L

BMO Field, Toronto

July 2, 2026
8:00 p.m. UTC-7

Winner Group B

Match 85
[Report 85]

3rd Group E/F/G/I/J

BC Place, Vancouver

July 3, 2026
1:00 p.m. UTC-5

Runner-up Group D		Match 88 [Report 86]	Runner-up Group G
AT&T Stadium, Arlington			
July 3, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC-4		Winner Group J	Match 86 [Report 87]
Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens			Runner-up Group H
July 3, 2026 8:30 p.m. UTC-5		Winner Group K	Match 87 [Report 88]
Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City			3rd Group D/E/I/J/L
Round of 16 July 4, 2026 12:00 p.m. UTC-5		Winner Match 73	Match 90 [Report 89]
NRG Stadium, Houston			Winner Match 75
July 4, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC-4		Winner Match 74	Match 89 [Report 90]
Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia			Winner Match 77
July 5, 2026 4:00 p.m. UTC-4		Winner Match 76	Match 91 [Report 91]
MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford			Winner Match 78
July 5, 2026 6:00 p.m. UTC-6		Winner Match 79	Match 92 [Report 92]
Estadio Azteca, Mexico City			Winner Match 80
July 6, 2026 2:00 p.m. UTC-5		Winner Match 83	Match 93 [Report 93]
AT&T Stadium, Arlington			Winner Match 84
July 6, 2026 5:00 p.m. UTC-7		Winner Match 81	Match 94 [Report 94]
			Winner Match 82

Lumen Field, Seattle

July 7, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-4

Winner Match 86

Match 95
[Report 95]

Winner Match 88

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

July 7, 2026
1:00 p.m. UTC-7

Winner Match 85

Match 96
[Report 96]

Winner Match 87

BC Place, Vancouver

Quarterfinals

July 9, 2026
4:00 p.m. UTC-4

Winner Match 89

Match 97
[Report 97]

Winner Match 90

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough

July 10, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Winner Match 93

Match 98
[Report 98]

Winner Match 94

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood

July 11, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-4

Winner Match 91

Match 99
[Report 99]

Winner Match 92

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

July 11, 2026
8:00 p.m. UTC-5

Winner Match 95

Match 100
[Report 100]

Winner Match 96

Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City

Semifinals

July 14, 2026
2:00 p.m. UTC-5

Winner Match 97

Match 101
[Report 101]

Winner Match 98

AT&T Stadium, Arlington

July 15, 2026
3:00 p.m. UTC-4

Winner Match 99

Match 102
[Report 102]

Winner Match 100

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Match for third place

July 18, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC−4

Loser Match 101

Match 103
[Report 103]

Loser Match 102

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

Final

July 19, 2026
3:00 p.m. UTC−4

Winner Match 101

Match 104
[Report 104]

Winner Match 102

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford

Statistics

Discipline

A player or team official is automatically suspended for the next match for the following offenses:^[161]

- Receiving a red card (red card suspensions may be extended for serious offenses)
- Receiving two yellow cards in the tournament;^[R] yellow cards expire after the completion of the group stage and again after the quarterfinals (yellow card suspensions are not carried forward to any other future international matches)^[162]

During qualification, Cristiano Ronaldo was sent off for violent conduct in Portugal's penultimate match against the Republic of Ireland, with such an offense typically resulting in a ban of at least two matches. Ronaldo was handed a three-match ban, though the final two matches of the ban were suspended for a one-year probationary period, making him eligible to appear in Portugal's opening World Cup match.^[163] On May 8, 2026, the Bureau of the FIFA Council amended the tournament regulations so that pending one- or two-match suspensions resulting from an indirect red card, a direct red card for denying an obvious goal-scoring opportunity, or a direct red card for serious foul play during qualification would no longer be carried forward to the final competition.^[164] This exempted Argentina's Nicolás Otamendi, Ecuador's Moisés Caicedo, and Qatar's Tarek Salman from serving their qualifying-round suspensions during the tournament, with the bans to instead be served in a subsequent competition.^[165]

Marketing

Branding

The official emblem and brand identity was unveiled on May 17, 2023, at the Griffith Observatory in Los Angeles, California; its basic form consists of a stacked "26" with an image of the FIFA World Cup Trophy in front of it (marking the first time that the trophy has been depicted in a World Cup emblem as a photo, as opposed to a stylized representation), but it is designed to be adaptable to different backdrops.^{[166][167]} The next day, FIFA unveiled variants of the emblem for each of the host cities, which feature color variants and designs that reflect local landscapes or culture (with the Los Angeles emblem featuring a stylized sun and wave, the Monterrey emblem featuring imagery of the Cerro de la Silla mountain, and Toronto featuring the city skyline and the CN Tower).^{[168][169]}



Countdown clock on Paseo de la Reforma, Mexico City

Reaction to the logo from the initial unveiling was largely negative, with many feeling that the design was either unfinished or uncreative compared to the emblems of past FIFA World Cup tournaments. By contrast, United States national team player Jesús Ferreira described the

emblem as "beautiful".^{[170][167][171]}

In March and April 2025, FIFA unveiled a set of 16 posters representing each of the 2026 World Cup host cities. The posters, designed by local artists, were intended to reflect the "distinct identity and heritage" of each host city.^{[172][173]} On March 3, 2026, the official poster was unveiled. For the first time, three artists combined their skills and artistic styles to create the official poster: Carson Ting (Canada), Minerva GM (Mexico), and Hank Willis Thomas (United States).^[174]



Official poster

Broadcasting rights

On February 12, 2015, FIFA renewed the United States and Canadian broadcasting rights contracts for Fox (US English), NBCUniversal (US Spanish), and Bell Media (Canada) to cover the 2026 World Cup, without accepting any other bids. A report in *The New York Times* asserted that this extension was intended as compensation for the rescheduling of the 2022 World Cup to November–December rather than its traditional June–July scheduling, as it created considerable conflicts with major professional sports leagues that are normally in their offseasons during the World Cup.^{[175][176][177]}

Fútbol de Primera has the Spanish radio broadcasting rights in the United States and Puerto Rico.^[178]

The International Broadcast Center (IBC) will be located at the Kay Bailey Hutchison Convention Center in Dallas.^{[179][180][181]}

On January 8, 2026, FIFA signed a deal to make TikTok a "preferred platform" for World Cup video content. As part of the agreement, broadcasters may stream parts of matches at a dedicated hub on the TikTok app.^[182] FIFA then made a similar "preferred platform" deal with YouTube on March 17, allowing broadcasters to stream select matches in full on their respective YouTube channels, as well as stream the first 10 minutes of every match on the platform as "an appetizer encouraging young fans then to watch on traditional channels".^[183] It was later confirmed that YouTube had extended this deal with FIFA and CazéTV to show all tournament matches for free in Brazil.^{[184][185]}

On May 8, 2026, Fox Sports announced a partnership with Cosm to show 40 matches, including the Mexico vs South Africa opening match, all United States matches, and the final.^[186]

Sponsorships

FIFA partners	FIFA World Cup sponsors	FIFA World Cup supporters
▪ <u>Adidas</u>^[187] ▪ <u>Aramco</u>^[188] ▪ <u>Coca-Cola</u>^[189] ▪ <u>Hyundai–Kia</u>^[190] ▪ <u>Lenovo</u>^[191] ▪ <u>Qatar Airways</u>^[192] ▪ <u>Visa</u>^[193]	▪ <u>AB InBev (Budweiser+Others)</u>^[194] ▪ <u>American Airlines</u>^[195] ▪ <u>Bank of America</u>^[196] ▪ <u>Frito-Lay (Lay's)</u>^[197] ▪ <u>Hisense</u>^[198] ▪ <u>McDonald's</u>^[199] ▪ <u>Mengniu Dairy</u>^[200] ▪ <u>Unilever (Rexona+Others)</u>^[201] ▪ <u>Verizon</u>^[202]	▪ <u>ADI Predictstreet</u>^[203] ▪ <u>DoorDash</u>^[204] ▪ <u>Inter Rapidísimo</u>^[205] ▪ <u>Marriott Bonvoy</u>^[206] ▪ <u>Rock-it Cargo</u>^[207] ▪ <u>Valvoline</u>^[208]

Regional supporters

North American supporters	South American supporters	European supporters	Asian supporters
▪ <u>Airbnb</u>^[209] ▪ <u>Diageo</u>^[210] ▪ <u>Globant</u>^[211] ▪ <u>Home Depot</u>^{[212][213]} ▪ <u>PIF</u>^[214] ▪ <u>Salesforce</u>^[215]	▪ <u>Betano</u>^[216] ▪ <u>Diageo</u>^[210]	▪ <u>Betano</u>^[216] ▪ <u>Globant</u>^[211] ▪ <u>Salesforce</u>^[215]	▪ <u>PIF</u>^[214]

Domestic sponsors

Atlanta	Boston	Dallas	Guadalajara
▪ Cox Enterprises^{[213][217]} ▪ Georgia-Pacific^{[213][217]} ▪ Home Depot^{[213][217]} ▪ NAPA Auto Parts^[218] ▪ Southern Company^{[213][217]}	▪ Coca-Cola Beverages Northeast^[219] ▪ Meet Boston^[220] ▪ Sanofi^[221] ▪ State Street^[221]	▪ Arca Continental^[222] ▪ Choctaw Casinos & Resorts^[223] ▪ Dallas Cowboys^[224] ▪ FC Dallas^[224] ▪ North Texas Sports Foundation^[225] ▪ UT Southwestern^[225]	▪ Guadalajara^[226] ▪ GNP Seguros^[226] ▪ Jalisco^[226] ▪ Zapopan^[226]
Houston	Kansas City	Los Angeles	Monterrey
▪ Aramco^[227] ▪ Arca Continental^[227] ▪ Houston Methodist Hospital^[227] ▪ Hunton Group^[227] ▪ Quanta Services^[227] ▪ Reliant Energy^[228] ▪ Rice University^[229] ▪ Visit Sugar Land^[230]	▪ Black & Veatch^[231] ▪ Hallmark^[232] ▪ Kansas City Chiefs^[232] ▪ Kansas City Royals^[232] ▪ J. E. Dunn Construction^[232] ▪ Populous^[233] ▪ Purina^[233] ▪ Sporting Kansas City^[232] ▪ University of Kansas Health System^[232]	▪ Amgen^[234] ▪ Archer Aviation^[234] ▪ Discover Los Angeles^[235] ▪ Kaiser Permanente^[234] ▪ Los Angeles Metro^[236]	▪ TBD
Mexico City	Miami ^[237]	New York/New Jersey	Philadelphia ^[238]
▪ Club América^[239] ▪ Farmacias Similares^[239] ▪ GNP Seguros^[239] ▪ Lilly^[239] ▪ Uber^[239]	▪ Bilzin Sumberg^[237] ▪ Brightline^[237] ▪ Griffin Catalyst^[237] ▪ Hard Rock Casino^[237] ▪ Royal Caribbean^[240] ▪ University of Miami^[237]	▪ Bristol Myers Squibb^[241] ▪ Hackensack Meridian Health^[242] ▪ Onyx Equities^[243] ▪ Paul, Weiss, Rifkind, Wharton & Garrison^[244] ▪ Public Service Enterprise Group^[245] ▪ Related Companies^[246] ▪ Sports Illustrated^[247]	▪ Cencora ▪ Comcast ▪ Independence Blue Cross ▪ PECO Energy Company ▪ Penn Medicine ▪ Philadelphia Eagles ▪ VisitPA ▪ William Penn Foundation
San Francisco Bay Area ^[248]	Seattle	Toronto	Vancouver
▪ Boston Consulting Group ▪ Electronic Arts ▪ Genentech ▪ Kaiser Permanente	▪ Alaska Airlines^[249] ▪ Amazon^[249] ▪ Emerald Queen Casino^[249] ▪ Microsoft^[249] ▪ Puyallup Tribe of Indians^[249] ▪ University of Washington^[249]	▪ Humber Polytechnic^[250] ▪ OLG^[251] ▪ OPG^{[252][251]} ▪ Toronto FC^[251]	▪ Bell Canada^[253] ▪ Coca-Cola^[253] ▪ Concord Pacific Place^[253] ▪ Musqueam Indian Band^[253] ▪ Pacific National Exhibition^[253] ▪ Science World^[253] ▪ Squamish Nation^[253] ▪ TransLink^[253] ▪ Tsleil-Waututh Nation^[253]

Advertising

On May 7, 2026, [Adidas](#) released *Backyard Legends: the Greatest Football Story Ever Told*, a 5-minute short film.^{[254][255]} On June 4, 2026, [Nike](#) released *Rip The Script*, a 6-minute short film.^{[256][257]}

FIFA fan festivals

FIFA will stage fan festivals in cities across the host nations, featuring matches on giant screens and live entertainment.^[258] Among the confirmed fan fest locations are Liberty State Park in Jersey City,^[258] Fairmount Park in Philadelphia,^[259] Fort York and The Bentway in Toronto,^[260] Centennial Olympic Park in Atlanta,^[261] and East Downtown Houston.^[262]

In January 2026, FIFA announced "Canada Celebrates", a series of events in over 40 communities throughout the tournament that features live viewings of the matches.^[263]

Tickets

Ticket prices for the 2026 FIFA World Cup initially ranged from \$60 for group stage matches to \$6,730 for the final—largely increased from the USD equivalent of \$69 to \$1,607 in the 2022 FIFA World Cup. However, in September 2025, FIFA confirmed it would use dynamic pricing for tickets for the first time, following the practice used in the 2025 FIFA Club World Cup.^[264] Hospitality seats were made available in April 2025 via FIFA's ticket partner for the event.^[265]

An initial draw period for non-hospitality seats occurred between September 10–19, 2025, limited to Visa cardholders. A second phase ran from October 27–31, and a third phase started after the final draw of teams on December 5. Sales are capped at four tickets per person per match, and no person is able to purchase more than 40 tickets for the overall tournament. FIFA's official resale platform went live on October 2, 2025.^{[264][266]}

A final "last-minute" sales phase reopened on April 22, 2026, approximately 50 days before the start of the tournament, with tickets for all 104 matches made available on a first-come, first-served basis. By that stage, more than five million tickets had been sold out of an expected total exceeding six million, with additional tickets scheduled to be released in phases up to the final, subject to availability.^[267]

Every city hosting the World Cup in the United States has passed a law stating that ticket sales to World Cup events are exempt from state and local sales taxes.^{[268][269][270]}

Merchandise

Video games

On October 2, 2025, FIFA announced the video game *FIFA Heroes*, scheduled for release in 2026 on Android, iOS, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, and Xbox platforms.^[271]

In May 2026, the *Football Manager 26* video game also announced the addition of licensed 2026 FIFA World Cup content.^[272]

In December 2025, Netflix announced a new simulation-type game featuring the World Cup, produced by Delphi Interactive and Refactor Games.^{[273][274]} In May 2026, it was announced the Netflix-published game would be titled "*FIFA World Cup – Launch Edition*" and would be released in June 2026.^[275]

In the same May 2026 announcement, FIFA also confirmed that they would adopt a non-exclusive "Digital Football" ecosystem, with games of various genres adopting the FIFA license. Alongside the new world cup game, were mentioned *FIFA Heroes*, *FIFA Rivals*, *FIFA Super Soccer*, *Football Manager*, *eFootball* and *Rocket League*, with more games joining the ecosystem in the following months.^{[275][276]}

Other products

Panini sticker albums were again announced for the 2026 World Cup. Due to the expansion of the tournament, each pack now contains seven stickers as opposed to the usual 5. In the United States and Canada, a set of 12 stickers was reserved for stickers that could only be obtained from Coca-Cola bottles, with each bottle containing a sticker printed inside the label.^[277] In May 2026, it was announced that the 2026 World Cup would be Panini's second-to-last tournament with a sticker album, after FIFA announced that Fanatics (via their Topps brand) would distribute collectables for FIFA tournaments from 2031.^[278]

In conjunction with the tournament, the [Lego Group](#) released a series of officially licensed FIFA World Cup 2026-themed construction sets. The collection included models of the FIFA World Cup Trophy, the official tournament emblem, a brick-built [Adidas Trionda](#) football containing a miniature stadium, and player-focused sets based on footballers [Lionel Messi](#), [Cristiano Ronaldo](#), [Kylian Mbappé](#) and [Vinícius Júnior](#). Several sets featured hidden references to the players' careers, alternative display poses, and commemorative World Cup-themed designs.^{[279][280]} To promote the product line, Lego organized FIFA World Cup 2026-themed activations in several markets, including a football festival and pop-up experience in [Singapore](#). The events featured interactive football challenges, football-themed Lego builds, displays of player-inspired models, and promotional giveaways tied to the World Cup collection.^{[281][282]}

Symbols

Mascots

The official mascots of the tournament were revealed on September 25, 2025, and are [Maple](#), [Zayu](#), and [Clutch](#). Maple is a [moose](#), Zayu is a [jaguar](#), and Clutch is a [bald eagle](#), representing Canada, Mexico, and the United States respectively.^[283] They were designed to reflect the cultural heritage of their respective countries.^[284]



Maple the Moose, Zayu the Jaguar, and Clutch the Bald Eagle

Match ball

On May 2, 2025, reports surfaced that the match ball would be called [Adidas Trionda](#). The design features red, green, and blue (the three colors representing Canada, Mexico, and the United States, respectively, and also featured on the host countries' flags), as well as a white wave connecting each of the colors, hence the name using the [Spanish](#) words for three ([tri](#)) and wave ([onda](#)).^[285] The design also features the national symbols of the three host countries (a [maple leaf](#) for Canada, a [golden eagle](#) for Mexico, and a [five-pointed star](#) for the United States) as well as gold embellishments to represent the [World Cup Trophy](#).^[286]



Adidas Trionda

Music

On May 17, 2023, the official theme song of the tournament was released, an instrumental track simply titled "FIFA World Cup 26 Theme Song".^[287] The following songs have also been released as a part of the official album.

No.	Title	Performer(s)	Length
1.	"The Official FIFA World Cup 2026 Theme"	Zachary Aaron Golden (writer)	2:02
2.	" Goals "	Lisa , Anitta , and Rema	3:00
3.	" Game Time "	Future , Tyla	3:27
4.	" Illuminate "	Jessie Reyez and Elyanna	3:04
5.	" Echo "	Daddy Yankee and Shenseea	2:16
6.	" Por Ella "	Belinda and Los Ángeles Azules	3:02
7.	" Three Nations "	21 Savage , Natanael Cano , and French Montana	3:30
8.	" No Place Like Home "	Major Lazer , Nelly Furtado , and Davido	2:35
9.	" In The Stars "	The Rolling Stones	4:59
10.	" Show Me "	Ayra Starr and Latto	3:28
11.	" Mi Mexico Lindo "	Alejandro Fernández	2:34
12.	" Blessings "	Stormzy , Fridayy , and Angel	3:36
13.	" Energy "	Ava Max and BIA	3:01
14.	" Lighter "	Jelly Roll and Carín León	3:00
15.	" Sir Sir "	Nora Fatehi , Vegeedream , and Sanjoy	3:06
16.	" Partidazo "	Danny Ocean	2:23
17.	" Champions "	IShowSpeed	4:16
18.	" Love Always Wins "	Shaggy , Cimafunk , and Zema	3:08

In March 2025, sixteen remixes of the theme song were released, which featured artists from each host city giving their own local spin to the song.^[288]

Awards

Prize money

In April 2026, FIFA confirmed the prizes for all participating nations. This edition's total distribution for the tournament will be \$871 million, \$431 million higher than the prize pool of the previous tournament. In addition to the performance-based prize money, each qualified team will also receive a \$10 million qualification payment and a \$2.5 million preparation fee before the competition.^{[289][290]}

Performance-based prize money based on final position

Place	Teams	Amount (in millions)	
		Per team	Total
Champions	1	\$50	\$50
Runners-up	1	\$33	\$33
Third place	1	\$29	\$29
Fourth place	1	\$27	\$27
5th–8th place (quarter-finals)	4	\$19	\$76
9th–16th place (round of 16)	8	\$15	\$120
17th–32nd place (round of 32)	16	\$11	\$176
33rd–48th place (group stage)	16	\$9	\$144
Total	48	\$655	

Individual and team awards

The following awards are due to be awarded at the end of the tournament.

- Golden Boot: Awarded to the tournament's top goal scorer.
- Golden Glove: Awarded to the tournament's best goalkeeper.
- Golden Ball: Awarded to the best overall player of the tournament.
- FIFA Young Player Award: Awarded to the best overall player of the tournament under the age of 21.
- FIFA Fair Play Trophy: Awarded to the team with the best disciplinary record that reached the knockout stage.

Controversies

Immigration

In June 2025, the second Trump administration reinstated a travel ban affecting citizens from multiple countries, citing "national security" concerns.^[291] The ban, which was later expanded in December, prohibits the issuance of new immigrant and non-immigrant visas for citizens of 39 affected countries, including those whose teams have qualified for the World Cup—Haiti, Iran, Ivory Coast, and Senegal. The proclamation includes an exemption for any athlete or member of an athletic team, including coaches, persons performing a necessary support role, and immediate relatives, traveling for the World Cup, Olympics, or other major sporting events as determined by the Secretary of State.^{[292][293]}

This exemption ensured that national teams' players, coaches, and staff of those designated countries would be permitted to enter the United States for the competition, but the US State Department confirmed that ordinary citizens of the four countries were not covered by this exemption, making them ineligible for visa issuance to attend the matches. While fans were permitted to submit visa applications with the promise of priority if they provided proof of tickets, the department noted that issuance

would be unlikely, barring rare "national interest" waivers. However, this restriction can be circumvented if a fan is a valid visa holder, a permanent resident, or a dual national who applies using a passport not subject to the ban. In such cases, applicants may still be eligible to enter or apply for entry, provided they satisfy all other immigration and security requirements.^{[294][295][296]}

In May 2026, the U.S. government decided to temporarily drop the \$15,000 visa bond requirement for fans from five African countries that have made it to the 2026 World Cup—Algeria, Cape Verde, Ivory Coast, Senegal, and Tunisia—as long as they have a valid ticket for the tournament.^[297]

Iran's participation

On November 27, 2025, the Football Federation Islamic Republic of Iran (FFIRI) said it would boycott the December 5 World Cup draw after its president, Mehdi Taj, was denied a visa to enter the United States. Four other delegation members, including head coach Amir Ghalenoei, were approved. An FFIRI spokesperson told state media the United States' decision was "unrelated to sport" and said the federation quickly raised the issue with FIFA President Gianni Infantino.^[298] However, on December 3, the FFIRI reversed its decision and announced that it would send representatives to the draw, with head coach Ghalenoei serving as the technical representative of the national soccer team.^[299]

FIFA has long promoted the World Cup under the slogan "Football Unites the World," presenting it as a symbol of global connection and harmony. However, several reports suggest that the 2026 edition is taking place in a more complex context, with political tensions, including those involving Iran and the United States, as well as security concerns and immigration and visa policies in the United States, potentially making participation in the tournament more difficult.^[300] Some analysts also describe the tournament as facing a mix of political, security, and logistical challenges at the same time.^[301] Some commentators argue that while FIFA continues to emphasize messages of unity, these conditions may undermine that narrative by highlighting divisions and unequal access for fans from different parts of the world, as illustrated by the Trump administration arbitrarily banning people of specific nationalities from entering the US.^[302]

Following a meeting with US President Trump on March 10, Infantino said that Trump had reiterated that the Iranian team "is, of course, welcome to compete in the tournament in the United States".^[303] In a post on Truth Social, Trump later added that, while the team is welcome, it would "[not be] appropriate that they be there, for their own life and safety".^[304] In response, Iran asked for FIFA to remove the United States as tournament hosts, referring to Trump's statement that the Iranian team's safety could not be guaranteed.^{[305][306]}

On May 10, 2026, Iran announced its demands for attending the World Cup, which includes visa guarantees for players, staff, journalists, and fans without further questioning by immigration authorities, security guarantees for players and staff, and "respectful" treatment of the Iranian flag, symbols, and national anthem. Requests were also made to have any press conference featuring the Iranian team to not include questions not related to the game.^[307]

On May 16, 2026, FIFA Secretary-General Mattias Grafström met with Iranian Football Federation officials in Istanbul to offer reassurance over Iran's participation in the World Cup, following concerns about the team's ability to enter the United States due to the ongoing Iran war. Earlier, Iranian FA President Mehdi Taj had been refused entry to Canada for the FIFA Congress due to his links to the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), which the U.S. and Canada classify as a terrorist entity. FIFA confirmed it was working with relevant authorities to ensure all teams could compete in a safe environment without discrimination.^[308] On May 19, it was reported that FIFA would again ban the pre-revolutionary Lion and Sun flag (used by monarchists to express support for the restoration of the Pahlavi dynasty) from World Cup stadiums, similar to previous World Cups.^{[309][310]} On May 26, FIFA faced the threat of a lawsuit from the Institute for Voices of Liberty, a group with ties to the US Government, for the ban imposed on the Lion and Sun flags.^[311]

On May 19, the Iran national team reached Istanbul to start the training camp for the World Cup. It was later confirmed that Iran would play a friendly in Turkey against Gambia before the start of the tournament.^{[312][313]} The Iranian Football Federation announced later that the Iranian national football team's training camp for the World Cup has been moved from the United States (in Tucson, Arizona) to Tijuana, Mexico, due to security concerns, which received official approval from FIFA.^[314] Iran's team received visas to enter the United States just ten days before their opening match against New Zealand, while some members of its coaching and administrative staff have not received visas, according to the Fars News Agency. The US State Department considers these individuals to be linked to Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps.^[315]

Bottle bans

FIFA has announced a ban on reusable water bottles inside all the stadiums during the 2026 World Cup. FIFA stated that the bottles are a safety hazard as they could be thrown causing injuries. The decision is widely criticized as most games will be played during the hot hours of the day, raising issues of hydration, fan welfare, and environmental impact. FIFA's reply was that it would provide hydration stations, cooling areas, and other measures.^{[316][317]}

Transit access

The car dependent construction of many of the US stadium venues drew negative commentary.^[318] The price of a round-trip rail ticket to the New-York-branded venue, MetLife Stadium in New Jersey, had increased from US\$13 to US\$98 (down from a previous high of US\$150, following a backlash.) Some visitors considered walking there along the Interstate 95 freeway.^[319] Officials responded by cutting off all pedestrian access to MetLife Stadium, blaming prospective pedestrians for causing harm to drivers and police officers.^{[320][319][321][322]} Some Americans dismissed the critique of US car dependency as Europeanism.^[318]

Notes

- A. Also marketed as **FIFA World Cup 26**^[1]
- B. Curaçao is the smallest country by area and the least populous to qualify for the World Cup. Excluding teams from the United Kingdom, Curaçao is also the first team representing a non-sovereign nation to qualify for the World Cup since the Dutch East Indies (currently Indonesia) in 1938.
- C. Until 1991, Uzbekistan was part of the Soviet Union, which competed at seven World Cup tournaments. Following the dissolution of the Soviet Union, Uzbekistan will become the third former Soviet republic to compete as an independent nation after Russia (1994, 2002, 2014 and 2018) and Ukraine (2006). FIFA considers Russia to be the successor team of the Soviet Union.
- D. From 1970 to 1998, DR Congo competed as Zaire. This will be the first time the country competes under DR Congo.
- E. Until 1992, the Czech Republic was part of Czechoslovakia, which competed in eight World Cup tournaments. Following its dissolution, the Czech Republic has qualified for the tournament for the second time as an independent nation, having previously debuted in 2006.
- F. Recognized as IR Iran by FIFA
- G. Recognized as Korea Republic by FIFA
- H. Recognized as Cabo Verde by FIFA
- I. Recognized as Congo DR by FIFA
- J. Recognized as Côte d'Ivoire by FIFA
- K. Recognized as USA by FIFA
- L. Recognized as Czechia by FIFA
- M. Recognized as Türkiye by FIFA
- N. The number in parentheses indicates the FIFA ranking of teams as of November 19, 2025.^[91]
- O. The winners of the UEFA playoffs and inter-confederation playoffs were not known at the time of the draw, as those matches were held on 26 and 31 March 2026.
- P. The placeholder for the inter-confederation playoff Pathway 1 winner adhered to the confederation restrictions of a CAF, CONCACAF, or OFC team.
- Q. The placeholder for the inter-confederation playoff Pathway 2 winner adhered to the confederation restrictions of an AFC, CONCACAF, or CONMEBOL team.
- R. As yellow cards are not carried forward to penalty shootouts, players may be shown two yellow cards in the same match without being sent off. However, this would result in a suspension for accumulating two yellow cards during the tournament.

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